Maternal age older than 35 years increases the risk of first trimester miscarriage, genetically abnormal fetus, medical complication (Hypertension, Diabetes, Eclampsia), multiple gestation, fetal morbidity and mortality.

c) Menstrual history

- Age of menarche
- Cycle : regular/irregular
- Amount and duration of blood flow
- LMP- date is counted from the first day of the last menstrual period
- EDD- calculate from LMP

b) Contraceptive history

Use of contraceptives copper T, or oral pills.

c) Past obstetric history

- Previous miscarriage
- Previous viable pregnancies
- Still births or neonatal deaths
- Method of delivery
- Gestational age, sex and weight of infants
- Previous antenatal or postnatal complications

d) Previous medical history

- Diabetes
- Cardiac diseases
- Hypertension
- Renal diseases
- Infectious diseases such as HIV, Hepatitis B or C

e) Personal history

- Smoking
- Alcohol
- Substance abuse

f) Family history

- Diabetes
- Hypertension
- Tuberculosis
- Twins

Examination

General state of health:

- Build - obese, average, thin
- Nutritional status - good, average, poor
- Gait - normal, with a limp,
- Postures - Kyphosis, Scoliosis, Lordosis
- Personal hygiene

Height – A short stature women (<145cm) may have a small pelvis leading to difficulty in labour.

Weight - Monitor for weight gain regularly

- Inadequate weight gain may indicate low birth weight baby,Intra Uterine Growth Retardation(IUGR)and poor perinatal outcome.
- Excessive weight gain may be due to fluid retention, pre-eclampsia, multiple pregnancies, polyhydramnios.

Pallor – It is a indicative of anemia, examine conjunctiva, tongue and nails for pallor.

Jaundice – Yellowish discoloration of the sclera, palate and skin.

Oedema – Examine for pitting oedema over the legs above the medial malleolus.

Breast and nipple – Observe the skin changes over the breast, gently palpate the breast for any tumor or nodule, look for any crack or retracted nipple.

Teeth and gums – women with dental carries, gingivitis or poor oral hygiene should be reported.

Varicosities – Note the presence of varicose vein and their distribution.

Vital signs – Record pulse, respiration, temperature and blood pressure and report any abnormality.

Abdominal Examination should be performed in each visit.

Steps of Abdominal Examination:

- Inspection
- Palpation
- Auscultation

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